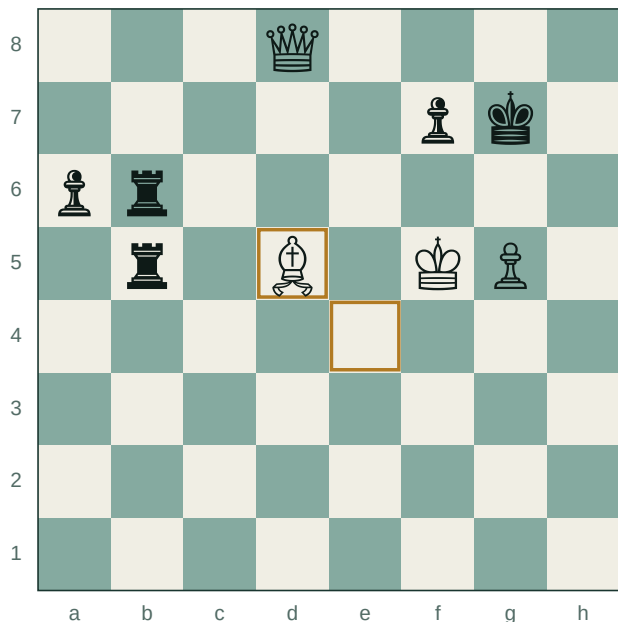


Clearance tactics: Black, move 61

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 61.Bd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

61...Rxd5+ 62. Qxd5 Rb5 63. Qxb5 axb5

61...Rxd5+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on f5 and queen on d8. Recorded reply: **62.Qxd5**.

62...Rb5 The rook moves from b6 to b5. Recorded reply: **63.Qxb5**.

63...axb5 The pawn captures the queen on b5.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f5. Absolute pin: bishop on d5.